

FUNCTIONAL ENGLISH

Faculty of English
General Education Program
Dow Institute of Health Professionals Education



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution
NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



1

1

PROFESSIONAL WRITING

- Formal Letters
- Business e-mails
- Memos



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution
NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



2

2

WHAT FORMAT FITS?

- Read each scenario in the PDF carefully.
- In your group, choose the best format for each scenario.
- Discuss and note **why** you chose it — think about:
 - Who the audience is (inside or outside the organization)
 - How formal or urgent the message should be
 - Whether a record is needed
- Be ready to share one or two of your choices and reasons with the class.



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution
NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



3

3

Identify the format (Letter, Email, Memo) for each of the following scenarios.

Scenario	Situation
1	New science lab opening hours need to be communicated to all students.
2	You need an official transcript for a scholarship application.
3	The printer in the faculty room is not working, and teachers need it today.
4	You want to apply for a Teaching Assistant (TA) position.
5	A colleague keeps arriving late to meetings — needs a reminder of professionalism.
6	HR announces a policy change about employee ID cards.



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution
NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



4

4

Scenarios no.	Audience	Urgency	Main Purpose	Format	Why
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					


DOW UNIVERSITY
 of HEALTH SCIENCES

This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.
 

5

5

Answers

Scenarios	Audience	Urgency	Main Purpose
1	Entire department	Not urgent but important	Inform/announce
2	Registrar's Office	Medium urgency	Request formal documentation
3	IT support	High urgency	Request quick action
4	Hiring committee	High importance	Apply formally
5	Internal colleague/team	Medium urgency	Advise/maintain standards
6	All employees	High importance	Announce new internal rule


DOW UNIVERSITY
 of HEALTH SCIENCES

This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.
 

6

6

ANSWERS

Scenario #	Best Format	Why
1	Memo	Internal announcement to many people
2	Formal Letter	Requires official documentation, external-facing
3	Email	Urgent internal request needing fast response
4	Formal Letter	Job application, professional impression required
5	Email	Internal, directed to one person, gentle reminder
6	Memo	Internal policy change to all employees

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Students will identify different components of letters and emails.
- Students will differentiate between the structure of letters and emails.
- Students will learn the purpose of writing letters and emails,
- Students will identify different components of memos.
- Students will learn the purpose of writing memos.

FORMAL LETTERS

- Preference for written communication outside an organization.

Examples: Letters written to government agencies or other businesses

- Significant for permanent record.

Examples: Resignation letter, employment letter

- Safeguard confidentiality.

Examples: Formal medical referral letter with confidential patient details

- Convey formality and sensitivity.

Examples: Letter of appreciation or scholarship award, or letter of condolence

- Deliver persuasive, well-considered messages.

Examples: Requesting a raise or promotion with justification

Advocating for new lab equipment with supporting reasons



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



9

9

PROFESSIONAL EMAILS

- Used for faster and more direct communication

Examples:

Asking a supervisor to confirm a meeting time

Sending documents required for today's deadline

Informing IT about a login issue

- Internal and external communication

Examples:

HR informing employees about training schedules

Inviting an expert to speak at a seminar

- Reach multiple people

Examples: Project head emails the same message to the entire team

- Digital record for accountability and documentation

Examples: Emails with deadlines, reminder emails, emails with attached documents



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



10

10

FORMATTING FORMAL LETTERS AND EMAILS

■ All well-written letters/ emails include several sections.

1. **Contact Information**
2. **Subject**
3. **Salutation**
4. **Body of Letter**
5. **Closing**
6. **Signature**



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution
NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.

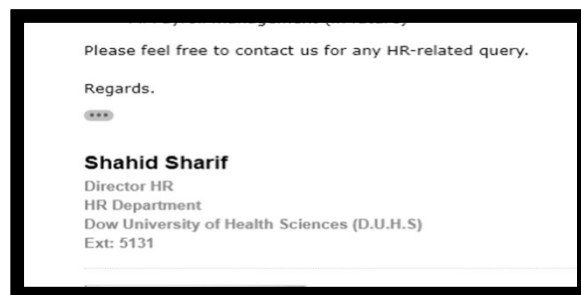


11

11

1. CONTACT INFORMATION

■ In an email message, your contact information will be at the end of the message, whereas in a written letter, your contact information is at the top of the page.



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution
NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



12

12

2. SUBJECT

- Short and precise
- Key words at the beginning
- Use logical search words

Examples:

- [Registrar Office] Ban on use of plastic bags
- Request for short leave/casual leave



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



13

13

3. SALUTATIONS

- Also called as greetings.

Formal salutations:

- Dear Mr. Smith
- Dear Mr. and Ms. Smith
- Dear First Name (if you know the person well)

General salutations: (When you do not know the person)

- To whom it may concern
- Dear Hiring Manager
- Dear Human Resource Manager
- Dear Sir or Madam



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



14

14

4. BODY OF LETTER OR EMAIL

- The body of your letter will include several paragraphs.
- The first paragraph should include **an introduction and a brief explanation of your reason for writing.**
- The second paragraph (and any following paragraphs) should **explain further your reasons for writing.**
- The last paragraph should either **request action from the reader, if you are requesting something, or state how you will follow-up.**
- Be sure to make the **purpose of your letter clear.**



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution
NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



15

15

4. BODY OF LETTER OR EMAIL

- The reader will need to know what you **are asking for and how they can help you.**
- Or, if you're **offering services or assistance**, make sure it's clear what you can provide.
- The language of your letter should be **formal, free of errors and ambiguity.**
- **Clarity of ideas** is key to your letter.
- **Punctuation, spellings and grammar** must be correct.



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution
NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



16

16

5. CLOSING

- A letter or email is closed with a term like **"Best regards"** or **"Sincerely"** followed by a comma
- Then **your signature** if you're sending a typed letter.
- If you're sending an email message, simply **type your name after the closing**.
- The finishing touch to your letter is your signature, which, in an email message, will include your contact information.

17

EXAMPLE: FORMAL LETTER

Ayesha Khan
BDS Final Year
Dow University of Health Sciences
Karachi, Pakistan

11 November 2025

The Manager
Healthcare Instruments Pvt. Ltd.
Karachi, Pakistan

Subject: Request for Replacement of Faulty Dental Handpiece

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to inform you that one of the dental handpieces recently purchased by our Prosthodontics Department has stopped functioning properly. The device shows an unstable rotation speed and produces excessive noise during operation.

The handpiece is still under the one-year warranty period (Invoice No. 1987, dated 20 July 2025). Therefore, I kindly request that the item be inspected and replaced at your earliest convenience, as it is required for ongoing patient procedures.

I have attached the purchase invoice for your reference. Please advise regarding the next steps.

Thank you for your prompt attention to this matter.

Sincerely,
Ayesha Khan
BDS Final Year
Roll No: 2021-BDS-145
Phone: 0333-1234567
Email: ayesha.khan@student.dohs.edu.pk

18

EXAMPLE: EMAIL

To: dr.ahmed@duhs.edu.pk
 CC: clinicaloffice@duhs.edu.pk
 Subject: Request for 2 Days Leave — 16–17 November

Dear Dr. Ahmed,

I hope you are well. I am writing to request two days of leave from my clinical duties on 16 and 17 November due to a scheduled dental procedure that I need to undergo.

I will ensure that all required case logs are updated and clinical responsibilities completed before my absence. Kindly let me know if you need any supporting medical documentation.

Thank you for your understanding and consideration.

Best regards,
 Ayesha Khan
 BDS Final Year — Seat No. 2021-BDS-145
 Dow University of Health Sciences
 Phone: 0333-1234567
 Email: ayesha.khan@student.duhs.edu.pk



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution
 NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



19

19

DECONSTRUCTING AN EMAIL

**Identify and label
the different parts
of the email in the
PDF.**

Subject: Request for Clinical Rotation Schedule Adjustment

Dear Dr. Ahmed,

I hope you are doing well. I am writing to request a minor adjustment in my upcoming clinical rotation schedule in the Oral Surgery department.

I have been assigned to the afternoon shift for the month of October. However, I am currently undergoing a medical treatment that requires weekly appointments at 3:00 PM on Tuesdays. I kindly request that my rotation shift on Tuesdays be changed to the morning session, if possible.

I assure you that I will complete all required clinical hours and maintain my responsibilities in the department. I am happy to provide medical documentation if needed.

Thank you for considering my request. I look forward to your guidance.

Sincerely,
 Ayesha Khan
 BDS, Final Year
 Seat No: 2021-BDS-145
 ayesha.khan@student.dohs.edu.pk



20

20

Email Component	Example from Email	Purpose
Subject Line	<i>Request for Clinical Rotation Schedule Adjustment</i>	Clearly states the topic so receiver understands purpose before opening
Salutation (Greeting)	<i>Dear Dr. Ahmed,</i>	Shows respect; uses correct title + last name
Opening Sentence	<i>I hope you are doing well.</i>	Creates polite and professional tone
Purpose Statement (1st Paragraph)	<i>I am writing to request a minor adjustment...</i>	Explains reason for writing immediately
Details / Justification (Body Paragraph)	Information about assigned shift and medical needs	Adds necessary context and evidence
Assurance / Professional Responsibility	<i>I assure you that I will complete all required clinical hours...</i>	Shows accountability and cooperation
Closing Remark	<i>Thank you for considering my request...</i>	Shows appreciation and goodwill
Closing Phrase	<i>Sincerely,</i>	Standard professional closing
Signature Block	Name, program, seat ID, email address	Identifies sender professionally + contact details

Choose the best answer.

- 1. I am writing to _____ you of a change of address. **a. inform b. warn c. instruct**
- 2. I sent an email last week to _____ information about the Philosophy course.
a. demand b. ask c. request
- 3. I _____ seven classes before I had to take time off for sickness.
a. assisted b. attended c. appeared
- 4. I am _____ about managing the workload of the course at the same time as my other responsibilities. **a. bothered b. concerned c. upset**
- 5. I think one _____ has been the difficulty in accessing the library as a distance student.
a. mess b. subject c. issue
- 6. _____, family circumstances mean it is difficult for me to study in the evenings.
a. Currently b. Actually c. Momentarily

MEMORANDUM | MEMO

- Memos are less **formal and shorter than a letter**.
- Used most often for **communication within one organization**.
- The **heading and overall tone** make a memo different from a formal letter.
- All information is on a **single topic**.

23

DEFINITION AND PURPOSE

Definition

- A memo is a **document** typically used for communication **within organization**.
- Memos can be as **formal as a business letter and to present a report**.

Purpose

- To give information to someone.
- To issue an instruction.
- To request help.
- To give suggestions.

24

STRUCTURE

Date:	Example:
To:	Date: January 5, 2024
From:	To: Waqas Ahmed, Manager
Subject:	From: Sana Ali, Human Resources
	Subject: Please Follow New Job Advertisement Process

STRUCTURE

- Opening paragraph **restates the memo's purpose** indicated in the **subject line**.
- Subsequent paragraphs build on the **opening statement** and **explain the memo's purpose in detail**.
- Word choice remains **straightforward and professional**.

To: All Final-Year BDS Students
From: Dr. Sara Malik, Clinical Coordinator
Date: 12 November 2025
Subject: Sterilization Protocol Compliance in Clinical Areas

All students are reminded to strictly follow the updated sterilization protocols in the diagnostic and procedural clinics. Several instances have been observed where instruments were not labeled or placed correctly in the autoclave tray, which poses a risk to patient and staff safety.

Effective immediately, please ensure the following:

- All instruments must be pre-cleaned and labeled before submitting for sterilization
- Autoclave log sheets must be completed and signed daily
- PPE must be worn when handling contaminated instruments
- Failure to comply may result in suspension of your clinical duties until corrective training is completed.

Your cooperation is essential in maintaining safe clinical practices.



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution
NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



27

27

Classify each sentence as more likely to appear in a letter or a memo.

- a) We are sorry to learn that you received the merchandise in a damaged condition.
- b) Hingorani Brothers have reported that they have still not received the supplies. Please investigate the causes and report.
- c) Hawaii Airways has collapsed. Many companies were using the airline, so we can now expect more customers.
- d) I am writing to confirm the details of our telephone conversation yesterday.
- e) To avoid any misunderstanding, I am confirming the points we agreed on yesterday in writing.



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution
NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



28

28

Classify each sentence as more likely to appear in a letter or a memo.

- f) I have attached a copy of the Surveyor's report on the insurance claim by Perfect Machines Ltd.
- g) I am pleased to enclose a copy of Suveyor's report on the insurance claim of Perfect Machines Ltd., for which a request was received from you last month.
- h) It has been more than two months since we opened a letter of credit in your favour, so we would be grateful if you could arrange the shipment of the goods as soon as Jon possible.
- i) Please write to Photo Imports and find out the reasons for the delay in shipment.
- j) We regret to say that despite three reminders, we have still not received payment for your last order.

Answers

- a, g, h, j : letter
- b, c, d, e, f, i : memo

WRITE AN EMAIL: Read the case notes from the handout provided.

- Using the information given in the case notes, write an email to Ms. Dennis, the Nurse-In-Charge at Stillwater Retirement Village, where the patient lives, recommending closer supervision of her oral care. Address the email to Ms. Veronica Dennis, Stillwater Retirement Village, 222 Main Road, Stillwater.

In your answer:

- Expand the relevant notes into complete sentences
- Do not use note form
- Use email format



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution NonCommercial-NoDerivatives 4.0 International License.



31

31

THANK YOU!

Reference:

- Guffey, M. E., & Loewy, D. (2019). *Essentials of business communication*. Cengage Learning.



32

32